BALAMURUGAN SIVARAMAN

Cloud & Network Security | SD-WAN | DevSecOps | SASE

NO.10/33, SASTHRI 3RD CROSS STREET, KAVERI NAGAR, SAIDAPET, CHENNAI – 600015.
+91-9003234312 s-balamurugan@zohomail.in Linkedin Technical Badges Portfolio

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PROFILE

Cloud & Network Security professional with **14 years** of end-to-end experience across enterprise networking, data center security, SDWAN, SASE, and **multi-cloud security (AWS & Azure)**. Builds **security-as-code** guardrails using Terraform and CI/CD, integrates CNAPP/CSPM platforms for scalable posture management, and drives securely by design adoption across teams. Recognized for bridging architecture and operations—turning standards into reusable modules, dashboards, runbooks, and patterns that scale. Blends cloud security, network architecture, identity integration, DevSecOps, and edge security to deliver secure, compliant, and reliable digital platforms.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E-ELECTRONICS AND COMMUNICATION ENGINEERING
DHANALAKSHMI COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY, CHENNAI 2006 – 2010

- Azure - Fundamentals / Security Engineer Associate
- Aviatrix Multi-cloud Network Associate – 2020-8020
- Palo Alto Networks Micro Credentials
- ·Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) – CSCO12347394
- Zscaler Certified Cloud Administrator – Internet / Private Access
- Redhat Certified Engineer (RHCE) – 8050119687588000

CORE SKILLS AND COMPETENCY

Cloud & Security Architecture: AWS & Azure Landing Zones · Network Segmentation · Zero Trust Principles · Secure Egress Design · Encryption & Key Management · Logging & Monitoring · Multi-Account / Multi-Subscription Design
Network & Edge Security: SASE (Zscaler, Prisma Access) · SD-WAN · Cloud WAF / DDoS · DNS Security · NGFW (Palo Alto, FortiGate, Check Point) · Hybrid Cloud Connectivity · F5 BIG-IP (LTM / GTM / ASM / APM)
Identity & Access Management: AWS IAM · Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) · OAuth2 / OIDC · RBAC · Workload Identities · Least Privilege Implementation · Conditional Access
DevSecOps & Infrastructure as Code: Terraform · Policy as Code (OPA) · CI/CD Security Controls · Azure DevOps · GitHub Actions · Drift Detection
Containers & Cloud Security Monitoring: EKS / AKS Security · Kubernetes Network Policies · Image Scanning · CNAPP / CSPM · Security Hub · SIEM / SOAR Integration
Governance & Risk: CIS Benchmarks · NIST 800-53 · MITRE ATT&CK · OWASP Top 10 · Risk Assessments · Audit Support

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PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

- Engineered reusable Terraform guardrails across multi-account AWS and Azure environments, enforcing IAM boundaries, encryption by default, centralized logging, and network segmentation — reducing misconfiguration risk through standardized cloud controls.

- Hardened EKS and AKS clusters by removing privileged pods, enforcing IRSA / workload identities, implementing OPA Gatekeeper admission controls, and mandating signed images — limiting privilege escalation and strengthening Kubernetes security posture.
- Eliminated long-lived access keys by implementing OIDC-based federation with short-lived tokens — removing hundreds of static secrets and significantly reducing credential exposure risk.
- Redesigned cloud networking into segmented hub-and-spoke architectures using Transit Gateway, VNet peering, private endpoints, and centralized firewalls — reducing east-west exposure and improving workload isolation.
- Operationalized CNAPP by correlating asset exposure, IAM privilege risk, and workload criticality to improve alert prioritization and focus remediation efforts on high-risk findings.
- Integrated workloads with Zscaler ZIA/ZPA and Prisma SASE using IPsec/GRE tunnels and identity-aware access policies — enabling secure access to private applications and reducing reliance on traditional VPN architectures.
- Embedded infrastructure scanning, container image scanning, secret detection, and policy validation into CI/CD pipelines — preventing high-risk deployments and enforcing shift-left security controls.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONSULTANT | HCL TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD. | AUG 2021 – PRESENT

Domain: Cloud Security | SASE | SDWAN | DevSecOps

- Designed and deployed **AWS & Azure cloud security guardrails** covering network segmentation, IAM boundary conditions, encryption defaults, diagnostics, and centralized logging, implemented via **enterprise-grade Terraform modules**.
- Built a **Security-as-Code validation platform** using Terraform + OPA/Conftest integrated into Azure DevOps/GitHub Actions, reducing misconfiguration by ~40–50% before production.
- Established a **unified CNAPP risk management pipeline** integrating Prisma Cloud, AWS Security Hub, and Microsoft Defender for Cloud with automated remediation and ticketing workflows.
- Conducted **cloud security architecture reviews** focusing on IAM design, segmentation patterns, secure egress strategies, encryption, Kubernetes hardening, and Zero Trust alignment.
- Defined Kubernetes **security baselines for EKS/AKS**, including network policies, namespace isolation, admission controls, image trust enforcement, and identity-based access.
- Modernized enterprise **SASE & SD-WAN architecture**, aligning Zscaler/Prisma Access identity-aware routing with cloud landing zones and segmentation models.
- Provided technical leadership for **risk assessments, threat modeling, and cloud control gap remediation** aligned with CIS, NIST 800-53, and Zero Trust principles.

TECHNICAL LEAD | COGNIZANT TECHNOLOGY SOLUTIONS | AUG 2018 – AUG 2021

Domain: Network Security Engineering | Cloud Enablement | Automation

- Delivered **WAF, DDoS, and API security modernization** across enterprise workloads using AWS CloudFront, Azure Front Door, and F5 platforms.
- Led **Terraform and Ansible automation frameworks**, reducing configuration drift and accelerating deployment cycles by ~30–40%.
- Integrated security telemetry into **SIEM/SOAR platforms** (Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk ES, Cortex XSOAR), improving detection fidelity and reducing MTTR for repeat incidents.

- Defined **security control baselines** and implemented automated guardrail checks for API gateways, WAF policies, DNS firewalling, and ingress/egress filtering.
- Supported **DevSecOps enablement** by embedding security validation into CI/CD pipelines for cloud and edge workloads.
- Performed **risk assessments and architecture reviews** for cloud migration programs, ensuring adherence to CIS benchmarks and organizational security policies.

IT ANALYST | TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES | MAY 2015 – AUG 2018

Domain: Data Center & Cloud Security Operations

- Operated **data center security and firewall platforms** (Palo Alto, FortiGate, Check Point) across global regions with strict adherence to SLAs and access governance.
- Supported early-stage **AWS and Azure cloud migrations**, mapping traditional security models (firewalls, segmentation, IAM, encryption) into cloud-native equivalents.
- Authored and maintained **security baselines, configuration hardening guides, and risk assessments**, enabling audit readiness across client environments.
- Implemented secure **VPN, ACL, and routing changes**, and responded to L3 security incidents involving network segmentation, IPS, and access violations.
- Strengthen cloud adoption readiness by contributing to **cloud networking, identity, and logging standards** across multi-account/multi-subscription structures.

NETWORK ENGINEER | QUADSEL SYSTEMS | OCT 2013 – MAR 2015

Domain: Enterprise Network & Security Support

- Delivered **enterprise firewall and network deployments** for BFSI clients under RBI/industry compliance controls. .
- Configured and supported **VPN, ACL, routing, and firewall rules**, ensuring secure connectivity across distributed environments.
- Conducted troubleshooting and assisted in implementing **network hardening best practices** for regulatory audits and security compliance.

EARLIER ROLES (2011 – 2013) 3i Infotech / InfoServices / Care IT Solutions

System & Support Engineer

- Provided L1/L2 support for **LAN/WAN, routing, VPN, firewall rule changes, and ACL management**.
- Managed ticketing, customer communication, and SLA-driven delivery for network support operations.
- Assisted with routine **configuration backups, patching, and firmware upgrades** across network devices.

KEY CLIENT ENVIRONMENTS

Western Digital • SanDisk Technologies • Sainsbury's • Pearson Global • Hasbro • John Lewis • Sundaram Clayton • MRF • Zoho • PwC • Lakshmi Vilas Bank • Standard Chartered Bank